

SCHADS & Health Services Award Compliance Checklist

A self-audit checklist covering the two award streams most relevant to NDIS support providers and medical or allied health practices, plus the cross-cutting payroll items that trigger Fair Work Ombudsman and NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission attention regardless of award. Work through each section before your next annual review, or before an auditor does it for you.

SECTION 1 SCHADS Award Checklist

For NDIS and disability support providers employing staff under the Social, Community, Home Care and Disability Services Industry Award (SCHADS).

- ☐ Every support worker is classified against the award's support worker schedule based on their actual duties, not a default or historical classification.
- ☐ Broken shift allowance is applied wherever a shift includes an unpaid break exceeding the award's threshold.
- ☐ Sleepover shifts are paid at the correct sleepover allowance rate, not processed as ordinary hours.
- ☐ Travel time and vehicle allowance are calculated for time spent travelling between clients during a shift.
- ☐ Casual loading (25%) is applied correctly, and not incorrectly stacked with other loadings on the same hours.
- ☐ Weekend and public holiday penalty rates are current and applied to every eligible shift.
- ☐ Minimum engagement and minimum shift length rules are being observed for casual and part-time staff.
- ☐ Overtime is correctly triggered and paid once ordinary hours thresholds are exceeded.
- ☐ Award rate updates have been incorporated from their effective date, including the Fair Work Commission's Schedule E changes for Home Care Employees, Disability Care, effective 1 October 2026, with further classification changes following from 1 October 2027.

SECTION 2 Health Services Award Checklist

For medical practices and allied health clinics employing staff under the Health Professionals and Support Services Award 2020.

- ☐ Every employee's classification level is correctly identified, administrative and support staff versus health professional classifications are not interchangeable.
- ☐ On-call and after-hours loadings are calculated on the correct base rate for that employee's classification.
- ☐ Saturday, Sunday and public holiday penalty rates are current and correctly applied.
- ☐ Junior, apprentice or trainee pay rates are applied correctly wherever they're relevant.

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- ☐ Relevant allowances, such as uniform or first aid allowances, are applied where the role genuinely qualifies.
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- ☐ Rostered and paid hours reflect actual hours worked each pay cycle, not a fixed assumption carried over from a prior roster.
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SECTION 3 Cross-Cutting Annual Audit Readiness

These apply regardless of which award covers your staff, and are consistently where Fair Work Ombudsman and other reviews start.

- ☐ Single Touch Payroll (STP) Phase 2 categorisation is accurate for every income type reported.
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- ☐ Superannuation guarantee is calculated on the correct ordinary time earnings and paid on time, at the current 12% rate.
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- ☐ Your business is ready for Payday Super, which from 1 July 2026 requires superannuation to be paid with every pay run rather than quarterly.
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- ☐ Employment records meet Fair Work Act 2009 record-keeping requirements, including pay slips issued within one business day of payment and records retained for the required period.
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- ☐ The correct modern award or enterprise agreement is documented against every employee's file.
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- ☐ Annual wage review increases have been applied from their 1 July effective date each year.
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- ☐ Long service leave accrual is tracked correctly under the relevant state long service leave legislation.
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- ☐ Termination payments, including notice and redundancy where applicable, are calculated correctly.
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A checklist like this one catches the obvious gaps, but it can't spot a misconfigured Xero pay item, an STP mapping error, or a superannuation calculation set up incorrectly at the system level. That's what a payroll configuration review is for, checking that your Xero file, pay items and rostering software are actually set up to produce the right numbers, and it's the next step once you've worked through the sections above.

Book a free 15-minute payroll configuration review

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